Kiss Me Goodbye

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/60360559.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Drummer Catra, Smut, Shameless Smut, angst with an ending, Angst, Exes, Girls Kissing, and a lot more, Implied/Referenced Character Death, Hurt No Comfort, rated E for emotional damage, Canon Lesbian Relationship, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Human Catra (She-Ra), Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Adora is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Canon Lesbian Character

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English

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Part 2 of Just One More Kiss

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by Døc (d0c_save_us_all)

Summary

She begins with some simple drum warmups. Nothing more than practicing rudiments on different parts of the kit, and she runs through her limb independence exercises a few times before putting on her headphones to actually play something.

Then her fucking phone rings.

Irked, she wipes the beads of sweat off of her brow and wonders who the fuck is bothering her. She knows it's not her moms. Her sister installed a light to the basement door that's hooked up to a light switch upstairs. If they want to talk to her, they'd just flick that switch, the light would go on, and she'd put the sticks and headphones down and see what they wanted.

She didn't expect to see the name Adora Greyskull on her screen.

Or
Just before heading off to Juliard for college, Catra tries to patch things up with her ex. It goes as well as you might expect.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Catra smiles as the ringing *crack* of the snare reverberates through her arm.

She adjusts her position on her drum stool a touch, pumping her right right foot down on the pedal a few times to give the kick drum a few cursory hits.

The batter strikes the massive drum head. A few tight, controlled, deep *thumps* echo off of the soundproofed walls of her parents basement.

She does the same with the toms, giving them a gentle tap with her sticks and listening as the notes gently fade.

She grabs her tuning key, disengages the snares and makes some adjustments. She runs through the entire kit again. Satisfied, she puts the tuning key down, and places her sticks on top of the snare drum. She stretches, and a few of her joints in her back, shoulders and hands pop. She shakes out her arms, and hangs them at her sides, before rolling her shoulders.

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Catra's pulse pounds in her ears. Her breathing becomes short and ragged. The room is spinning around her, but time feels

frozen. She doesn't know what she's feeling. Anxiety? Panic? Fear? All she knows is that she can't will herself to hang up on her, and that she's too much of a pussy to pick it up.

She lets it go to voicemail.

"Hey, Catra." Adora's voice crackles out of the busted speakers of Catra's phone, *"It's Adora. I know that you are probably still mad at me and everything, given– you know. But um, uh."* Adora sighs *"I miss you a lot, and I have something important to tell you before you go to New York. I really hope you are doing okay."* A long awkward silence follows.

She clears her throat, *"If you want to talk, just contact me and I'll send you my address. I know this is really short notice, but it's important."*

"And if you decide not to come, I just wanted to say that I-"

Catra deletes the voicemail before Adora finishes her sentence. She takes a few calming breaths, paces the length of her room half a dozen times while trying to refrain from pulling her hair out. This is… a lot for her.

She considers sitting back down and practicing her rudiments on every fucking limb. Maybe some limb independence exercises. Try and play *Backbone* until she slips a disc. She just needs to *practice* until her head clears. Or one of the blisters on her hands ruptures. It'll pretty much have the same effect.

She blinks the tears out of her eyes. Fuck.

I'm really fucking pathetic, aren't I?

She now understands why her therapist said that blocking Adora might have been the best option. Receiving a call from Adora nearly sent her into a panic attack. The sound of her voice *alone* is causing her emotions to fly out of her control.

She should let it go, maybe talk to her moms or her foster sister before making any decisions. She can sleep on it, she has five days until she has to leave for New York. Instead, she unlocks her phone, opens messages and opens Adora's messages. She hasn't brought herself to change her contact photo, which is a photograph of them kissing at sunset after a hike, or unpin her texts in the app.

The last message on here is Catra's, sent three months ago. It reads *You made your choice, now live with it,* back when Adora tried to convince her that they could still be *friends* a week after she broke them up. The texts that Catra sent in response were so fucking vicious and intentionally hurtful that she really doesn't blame Adora for not trying to contact her since. She can't even look at them long enough to delete them without feeling sick.

Can't believe you had the guts. She taps out. She immediately erases it. Too cruel. She doesn't mean it, anyway. *I missed you.* She deletes that. Too personal, too needy, too close to how she actually feels. *I'm sorry.* That's better said in person.

She takes a deep breath. She's going to really fucking regret this.

I got your voicemail, what's your address?

Adora slams Catra's back against her bedroom door. Strong, smooth hands grip the straps of her tank top, holding her in place as soft, warm lips press against her own. They roll off of the door as Adora fumbles for the doorknob. Adora pushes them through the door, and gently guides Catra to the wall after she kicks the door shut.

They don't kiss how they used to. This is hungry, desperate, demanding. Adora's impatient with her tongue, much to Catra's surprise. She's so stunned that she lets her tongue tangle with

hers, moaning deeply, letting the waves of pleasure and yearning flow through her and ravage what little is left of her self-control. Those strong hands finally grab the zipper and pull it down, pushing the jacket off of her shoulders and pulling her mouth off of Catra's.

Catra gasps at the trails of spit connecting them, her heart surging and her core throbbing in lewd, slick pulses of arousal. Every touch is electric, every breath, every sound, every movement that Adora makes drives her out of her mind. Catra feels like the faintest suggestion of a person under Adora's touch, just wet clay begging to be shaped and molded into whatever Adora wants her to be. She'll let her, just so Adora can have the Catra she wants. Even if that mutual willingness to *sacrifice* was what broke them in the first place.

But Adora treats her as something fragile, because she knows that about Catra. Her stare is reverent, like she is in awe of what's under her. A frailty only Adora ever gets to see. The faint grazing over her fingers flitting over her skin has her core aching desperately. Her body strains under Adora's touch, and she has no idea how she can live without this again. How can she even *be* without this? How will she even *be,* after this?

She wants her, needs her. Her heart, mind, and body had been deprived of Adora for three months. Having Adora here, like this, is far beyond driving her wild. It's far beyond just *want,* it always was, but she isn't going to deny Adora. She can't, not really.

After today, this deeply interconnected first chapter of their lives will most likely be over. It shouldn't have been, but it will be. Adora had a scholarship lined up for Manhattan University, and Catra was heading to fucking *Juliard* . She was going to achieve her dream with the woman she loved at her side. Life finally stopped shitting on her for *one moment,* and for a few months, everything looked like it was going to be okay*.*

Then Adora tore her meniscus and lost her scholarship. Angella dropped dead in the bathtub from a brain hemorrhage less than

two months later. She didn't expect Glimmer to turn bitter and blame Adora for their mother's death. She didn't expect Adora to suffer a catastrophic nervous breakdown so complete that she narrowly failed her last semester at high school.

Catra tried to be there for her the best she could. She spent nights over at Angella's house, making sure Glimmer didn't say anything that could push Adora over that final, desperate edge. When that task became impossible, she asked her parents if Adora could stay with them. She held Adora as she cried herself to sleep as she insisted that she was a *complete and utter failure.* She made sure Adora ate, made sure she slept, and drove her to school everyday. She told her that she loved her every chance she could get, and that she wouldn't leave her, no matter what.

It was the night after graduation when Catra floated the idea of taking a gap year. The moment the words left her mouth, the air seemed to shift. She fell cold and silent in Catra's arms, her body stiff like a corpse. She wasn't as affectionate, she was *off.* For most of that week, Catra wondered if the shoe finally dropped, if Adora finally realized *who* she fell in love with. If she finally recognized how fundamentally unlovable Catra truly was.

Catra gasps when Adora puts her lips to Catra's neck and *sucks* gently. Her body shakes from how aroused she is. Adora is so much, an undertow that just pulls Catra under and drowns her.

Catra feels more *awake* than she's ever felt in her life. She never expected to find clarity in Adora's touch again, bound so vividly into this moment together. She can feel the texture of her lips on her throat, trailing lower, and lower, and lower still as Adora's hands savor the shape of her body. Catra releases a gasping moan.

"I've missed you. So much." Adora whispers. Adora's words get caught in her choked, tight throat. Tears shine in her eyes.

The moment is too charged, too intimate, too tender to be a feverish makeout in Adora's dingy apartment. And by the looks of

it, it's about to go a lot further than that.

She pulls away, and she can read the disappointment in Adora's eyes.

"I missed you too." Catra whispers back with a trembling voice. She didn't realize that she was on the verge of crying.

"I don't want to stop. Can we keep going?" Catra asks. It tears Catra apart to realize that she is *afraid* of asking this question. It reminds her of what they once had in the worst way. The passion is here, the desire, the attraction, the compatibility, all of it. But the trust isn't. The lines of communication have been ripped out of the ground and burned to ash, and neither of them know how to even start establishing them again.

Adora gasps, her eyes wide in astonishment.

"Are you sure?" Adora asks, a barely contained joy and *relief* coating each word. Catra smiles through her heartbreak, and brings her hand to Adora's face, planting a gentle kiss on her lips.

"Yes, If you want." The *me* remains unsaid. She hopes she doesn't need to be.

"Of course." Adora whispers, cupping Catra's face and staring at her like she is the only thing in the world, "Always."

Catra kisses her again, if only to avoid bursting into tears. Fuck, she missed Adora. She lets the faint taste of Adora's toothpaste soak into her senses, pushing one of the straps of Adora's tank top off the blonde's shoulder before leaving a trail of feather light kisses down her throat.

This time, Catra bites gently on the soft skin of her neck, and that gets a *reaction* out of Adora. She chokes back a moan. Her pupils dilate even further, her irises rings of blue circling a gaping abyss. Her hips buck involuntarily, and she flushes. Adora sounds as just desperate as Catra feels. So she decides to show it.

Catra growls under her, and pushes Adora back until she falls on the bed, propping herself on her elbows as Catra climbs on top of her.

Adora fidgets with the hem of Catra's shirt, eyebrows raised in a silent question. Catra answers with a nod, and the *Gojira* band tee is off before she can blink. Adora's eyes scan up and down her torso, before gasping.

"You are so fucking beautiful." Adora whispers, the words sounding painful and thick with emotion. "Catra-."

"Then-" *why did you end us?* Catra catches herself. The words that pour from Adora's lips, filled with regret, should fill her with hope. But she knows Adora too well. Adora can turn regret into the foundations for resolve. She knows that Adora's hurting just as much as she is, but that doesn't inspire any hope in her. Adora, like nobody else can, will use the pain of deprivation and twist that into a reason to deprive herself further. She did it in the foster home, she did it in their relationship, and she'll do it now.

Regardless, Catra knows the answer to her own question. Adora, on some level, recognizes Catra for who truly is. An empty shell held together by talent, spite, and whatever Adora's told herself fills the hollow spaces in between. Adora wants to love a person, with thoughts and feelings. Catra isn't a person. Catra is a black hole, consuming all pity and love anyone sends her way and incapable of letting anything genuine escape her toxicity.

"Catra, I- I-" Adora stammers under Catra's lips, and it's so desperate, so warm, so fucking fond and full of an emotion that Catra dares not name.

"Don't say it." Catra pleads breathlessly. She couldn't handle however that sentence would end, given the look in Adora's eyes. There was no way that it could end that wouldn't reduce Catra into an emotionally volatile wreck, or strip her of any desire not to just break down and beg. Beg for her back, beg for anything. Let what's left of her resolve break and let them be friends again like

Adora wanted, even though it would never be enough. She wants, *needs,* to have all of Adora. It is a hunger, something that feels written onto her very *soul*. She loves Adora, always has, always will. Anything less than everything would kill her.

She knows that Adora feels the same. She saw it in how Adora lit up when she saw her for the first time in months, how she hung off her every word when she spoke. Not to mention the small, intimate touches that spoke volumes on their own.

Catra wants her again, she wants to give Adora what she they both want, even though Catra didn't give her a chance to say it. Catra wants her back, more than anything she's ever wanted anything.

But there is a small piece of herself that *knows better.* She knows matter how this goes, no matter what they talk about tomorrow, even in the best case scenario where she'd say *I still love you, and what I did was a mistake and I want you back,* Catra is setting herself up to get hurt.

When they began dating in freshman year, the transition from *friends* to *girlfriends* felt more like coming home than anything else. Just completing the final piece of the puzzle that was *them* . Adora was always her home, always a part of her. Just knowing that Adora was there, that she had someone who loved her, was enough to get her through her worst days. But Adora could never understand that, how Adora wanting her could be enough. Adora always saw the needs of others as more important than her own. It's what broke them the first time. It's what will break them again.

Catra wouldn't survive losing Adora again. To be frank, Catra doesn't know if she can survive being *with* Adora again. They haven't discussed Catra's behavior during the breakup. Knowing Adora, they won't.

All signs point to failure. All signs point to the same fucking issues they've always had, but without the trust they've taken for

granted since they were toddlers. Adora doesn't have the willingness to confront what Catra did, and Catra isn't willing to start the argument, lest she lose her temper again, lest she fuck it all up *again.*

They are broken. Permanently, irreparably, deeply broken in a way neither of them can ever fix. All staying is going to do is just make Catra aware of exactly how broken they are, how far the cracks web into the foundations of their relationship.

She can't… She can't do this. She can't put herself through this. No matter what, she's lost Adora. The only question left is how long is she willing to make both of them suffer before it becomes painfully obvious how broken everything is. Maybe they were always going to fail, but Catra wasn't able to see it until now.

She won't put either of them through this again. She-

Anything resembling thought vanishes as Adora sucks a mark into her neck. Catra's back arches, her hips bucking involuntarily against Adora's thigh, that barest hint of contact making her clit throb and her core spasm. The waves of pleasure and want are so intense that they are nearly maddening.

She groans Adora's name, and it's a broken thing. She stutters out each choked syllable, and the end of her name is just consumed by another moan as Adora's hands palm Catra's breasts, gently kneading them while the ghost of a thumb grazes her nipples. She should be ashamed of how her body surges forward, leaning into Adora's touch and caving into her desire in ways that she is too proud to admit out loud.

Catra's hands roam up and down Adora's powerful arms, memorizing the shape of the muscles beneath the skin. She loves how the sweat on her skin glints in the evening sun as it streams through Adora's window, how powerful Adora looks, and how safe that makes Catra feel. She misses how she used to see her like this almost every night, had the option to touch her and savor her like this whenever she wanted.

Catra tugs Adora’s tank top off and throws it into a random corner of the room. Adora giggles, her smile free and careless, if only for an instant, and it makes Catra’s heart hurt more than anything.

It might- no, *will* be- one of the last times she’ll hear Adora laugh in her entire life. She’ll savor the sound however she can.

She smoothes her hands across Adora’s body, trying to commit the shape of her body to memory. Every dip, curve, and scar. Especially the scars, and the memories that are bound to them. She doesn’t ever want to forget any part of her. Not the gentle weight of Adora’s breasts on her own. Not the way the curve of her ass feels under her hands. Not the way Adora’s abs feel against her stomach. The way she smells earthy, like the faintest hint of lavender and basil. Not any of it.

Catra couldn’t forget how Adora makes her feel if she tried.

Catra pushes Adora onto her back, watching her breasts bounce and then sag towards the side of her body, and latches her lips onto one of them. She savors the sensation of Adora’s soft skin under her lips, circling her nipple with her tongue as her hand attempts to palm the other. She slowly kneads Adora's other breast, firm and full, listening carefully to each moan that slips through Adora’s lips, every sound she makes. The way Adora’s nipples feel under her lips is addictive. She doesn’t want to stop, she can’t stop.

She sucks hard on Adora’s nipple, and Adora whines beautifully, her back nearly arching off the bed. Catra used to see this every other night.

So she takes her time, gently groping Adora’s breasts and sucking hickies into her skin as Adora traces Catra’s entire body with her hands. They are both going overboard on the foreplay, she knows this, but she wants to show at least a fraction of what she feels for Adora. What she has always felt, will always feel.

“Catra?” Adora whispers, her hands freezing. Her eyes are shining in the moonlight, and they are both suspended in this moment. It occurs to her that she can go back on her decision, to come clean, to tell her how she still *feels,* acknowledge how they both still feel. Adora would probably be willing to work something out. A small part of her screams that *they can still fix this,* as long as they talk right here, right now. She doesn’t *need* to lose Adora.

“I’m fine.” She lies, like a coward.

Adora flinches, and she looks hurt, but she understands. In the ethereal light from their window, Catra can see tear tracks reflected on her cheeks. It breaks her heart.

It’s been breaking her heart all summer, and it’s been tearing at it fiber by fiber ever since they met up this evening to talk. It feels like Adora is flaying her heart, unspooling the organ until all that’s left are tiny fibers of blood-dyed thread. She considers telling her when she releases Adora’s nipple from her lips, but she silences herself kissing lower, and lower down her body. Inch by inch. Every kiss elicits another noise from Adora. A moan, a sigh, or a delicate, needy whine. She trails her lips under her breasts, across her solar plexus, and over the abs that have driven Catra wild for years. She spends extra time there, circling around her stomach before trailing lower, lower, and lower still.

She teases the hem of Adora’s pants with her fingers. She cocks an eyebrow in a silent question.

“Please,” Adora answers, so desperate and perfect and *gone* . Catra shudders.

“Please, what?” She asks, her voice ragged with desire. She wants to hear it, needs to hear Adora say it.

“Fuck me, Catra.” Adora answers, smiling sadly as she looks down at her.

Catra shimmies out of her shorts before undoing the button on Adora’s jeans, wiggling them off her hips and thighs until she can

pull them roughly off of her and tosses them in the ever growing pile of clothing behind them. And every reservation about how this night is going dies the moment she sees Adora nude.

To see Adora like this again is beyond words. She needs to feel her body on hers, she needs to see Adora come undone under her touch, she needs to feel Adora's hands on and *in* her.

She pounces on top of Adora. straddling her hips and choking down tears as she pulls Adora close. Adora puts their heads together, and kisses her *slow.* The delicate slide of their lips is intoxicating, and their tongues gently weave together. It's perfect.

Catra caresses Adora's legs, watching the muscles in her thigh ripple under her soft skin. The scars from Adora's surgery have faded, and she's regained most of the muscle she'd lost after the operation. It turns Catra on so much. She traces the outline of her legs, and places gentle kisses on her surgery scars.

"You aren't going to ruin your future for a failure like me." Was what Adora said when she broke them up.

'You were never a failure.' Catra tries to convey with each kiss, *'Not to me. Never to me.'*

Catra presses her lips to Adora's inner thigh a few inches above her knee, and begins to inch up toward her pussy, planting the lightest of kisses as she strokes up and down Adora's body.

"Holy fuck, Catra" Adora flexes, arches her back, and moans. She's gripping her pillow above her head with one hand and gripping her breast with the other. "That feels so fucking good."

Catra smugly smiles against Adora's leg, turning to continue the process on the other. Adora squeaks, moans, and spasms under her.

By the time Catra reaches her folds, Adora is so fucking slick that it sends a shiver down Catra's spine. She kisses around her, feeling Adora spasm beneath her lips as she whines and squirms

in her grip. “Just fuck me already, Catra.” Adora runs her hands through Catra’s messy mane of hair, the gentle drag of fingernails on her scalp lulling her deeper and deeper into her own arousal. “I want you, so much.”

She will bid every fucking inch of Adora a fond farewell. She will worship her body, she would pour all the love that she had left into Adora as she truly comes apart for her. She will memorize her taste, the sound of her moans, the faces she makes as she approaches the edge of bliss. She will commit this *last time* to memory, keep it safe and tucked away, to be remembered fondly when her heart aches in the empty years ahead of her.

But now? Now she’ll just lose herself in Adora.

Spent and shuddering, Catra collapses on to Adora’s bare chest. She feels weak, truly boneless after the intense orgasm that she just had, and she just…

She just wants to feel Adora against her. Just a little while longer.

Apparently, Adora feels the same, because she pulls Catra into her chest, Catra’s face plastered just above Adora’s left breast. Adora caresses gently down Catra’s back, and it feels so much like their first time that it *hurts.*

She even wore the shirt they bought at the concert. Meeting up with her was such a *stupid* idea.

Catra had missed this so much. She just wants to curl into Adora and sleep in her arms until morning, listening to the sound of Adora’s powerful heartbeat. Feel the slow rise and fall of her chest as she breathes. Press her cheeks into the softness of Adora’s skin and just lie here, feeling loved.

Because that's how she feels right now. That's what she gathered from all of this. Adora still loves her, and has been almost, if not just as distraught as Catra over the entire summer.

Adora shifts Catra in her arms, turning to look directly into her eyes. She reaches up to brush some of Catra's hair out of her face. She pulls her into a gentle kiss. It's gentle, chaste, and that makes it feel like it promises so much *more*.

"We'll talk tomorrow." Adora whispers, and Catra's heart skips a beat, a chill sinking into her bones. "Promise?"

"Yeah." Catra sighs. The ease of the lie leaves a faint sting in her chest that pales in comparison to the sinking feeling in the pit of her stomach, "Promise."

Catra waits for Adora's breathing to slow, for her to fall into a deep sleep, before she starts pulling herself out of Adora's arms. Her limbs feel like lead, and every single cell in her body is screaming at her to *stay* like she promised. But she knows what she has to do, she knows what she *needs* to do.

Adora is smiling in her sleep, her hands gripping at Catra, trying to pull her in closer. Adora looks so carefree, so unburdened, so *happy,* that Catra has to put her hand up to her mouth to dampen the sob that slips through her lips. Adora sleeps like a rock, though, so she doubts it will wake her up.

This, she realizes, is the last time she'll ever see Adora smile. This, this moment right here, is the *end*. 13 years of friendship, joy, and love reaching their conclusion with Catra slinking away in the dark of night at 1:30am after fucking Adora senseless. Breaking both of their hearts instead of keeping her promise to stay the night and *talk* .

Selfish, she thinks. *Coward,* she agrees.

Will Adora think that, tomorrow morning? That Catra used her? Maybe just wanted a warm body to hold? Or would she understand why Catra couldn't stay. Would she finally understand

how futile it would be to be friends again, given how ruined and broken they are. Or how Catra's too broken to do anything but ruin any chance they have at happiness.

The smile falters as she slips out of Adora's grip, and Catra gathers her clothes and gets dressed.

As she turns to go, she chokes back another sob, and her feet pull her to Adora's bedside before she can realize what she's doing. Adora mumbles something under her breath and pulls her in.

She stares at Adora for too damn long. She memorizes her face, every dimple and acne scar, the shape of her nose, the fullness of her lips.

She wants this moment to last forever. It should have lasted forever. It was *supposed* to be forever.

She wants to tell her that she hasn't really played for herself since they broke up. That all she feels when she sits behind her kit is a yawning emptiness. How, when she takes to the stage, she breaks down in tears at after every show because of how much she missed her. She wants to tell her that the one time she completed a runthrough of a song that Adora loved, she broke down into tears and had to run to her bedroom to scream into her pillow. All it did was remind her of a fourteen year old Adora smiling and telling her how *amazing she was*.

She wants to tell her that she feels empty without her. Like a piece of herself has been carved out of her body. She wants to tell Adora how lonely she is, that she's cut Glimmer, Bow, and even *Lonnie* out of her life. How Entrapta and their parents are the only friends she has left, and how she feels that she's growing more distant from them every day. How her mom, slightly buzzed after a fourth of July dinner party, confessed to her that ever since the break up she's been terrified that she's gonna wake up one day and find Catra dead.

There is so much she wants to say, but there is only one thing that truly matters.

"I love you," she whispers, her already delicate voice breaking.

She leans in and kisses Adora's forehead, slow but soft, Catra takes a deep inhale, smelling her shampoo, and that hint of burnt rosemary and lavender. She focuses on how Adora's skin feels under her lips, soft, smooth, and warm. Adora's smile widens just a touch. She can feel *something* begin to stretch and fray inside of her heart, slowly tearing and unwinding as it is being pulled fatally taunt.

She doesn't want to be here when it breaks.

"Goodbye, Adora." She whispers, and she slips from Adora's bed.

She slides out of bed and quietly tiptoes out of the apartment, picking up her shoes with her hand. When she's quietly closed the door behind her, she slips down the hall and anxiously waits for the elevator to put her out of Adora's possible sightline. The moment the elevator doors close, she unlocks her phone. Her fingers shake so much that she accidentally opens another app before she manages to pull up Adora's contact information.

The seconds that she stares at that red line of text seem to stretch on for infinity. Her weak, feeble heart, the one that still belongs to Adora, screams that it's a *mistake* . Catra knows it's a mistake. There is a chance that they could fix this.

She blocks her anyway.

She doesn't feel any sense of relief. She doesn't feel lighter. She doesn't even feel agonizing anguish or existential dread. She just feels empty, cold, and numb. Like a hollow shell of a person stuffed with gauze, the first few notes of dread gnawing at the periphery of her heart. She is so far removed from her physical body that it seems to just move on its own. It puts on her boots before she leaves the building, walks to her car, and gets in.

Driving home feels like she’s buried under fifty panes of glass. She’s turning the wheel, navigating the web of streets that is Hanover, New Hampshire, stopping at lights and using her turn signals. but it all feels so distant. Like she is just a passenger in her own body, and somebody else is driving.

Her body slowly comes back to her as it pulls into her family's driveway. She steps out of the car, and unlocks the front door. She quietly steps into her house, locking the door behind her. It’s 2 in the morning, and her moms have a long fucking drive ahead of them. Not to mention, given the state of Catra’s neck, they are probably going to have a *long* talk in the car about what happened tonight.

When she slips into her room she pulls her drum pad out of her bag. She needs to direct how she’s feeling outward, otherwise she might do something rash. Something permanent.

She lets the thought pass, grabbing her sticks, puts on her playlist of Drumeo warm up exercises, and begins tapping a simple pattern against the snare pad as she lays in bed.

She works her way through increasingly complex sticking patterns, and makes her way roughly half way through the slog of a playlist until she can’t anymore, chucking her sticks across the room. She can’t feel anything except for a yawning emptiness and it makes a part of the back of her mind *livid*.

She feels exactly when that last fraying fiber snaps. Her heart blooms in cold, wet agony, and she wonders if this is what it feels like to bleed internally. This new emotion flows through her body, making her limbs feel like lead and every breath labored. It feels like dread, it feels like dying. It’s heartbreak, it’s grief. It’s the feeling of something deep, unspeakable, and wrong.

She slams her laptop shut and buries her face in her bedsheets.

Once, Adora made everything worth it. Once, Catra could pretend that life was worth living. Once she dreamed of going to college,

becoming a professional musician, and marrying the girl she'd loved before she even knew what love was. She remembers the smile that Adora gave her the first time she played. She remembers their first date, their first kiss, their first time. She remembers begging to stay overnight at the hospital to make sure she was okay the night she got injured. She remembers when the idea of New York held freedom and promise.

None of that feels like it's true anymore.

She lets the tears come, she lets the sobs shake her body to its foundations as she screams into her pillow. The vague sound of her moms knocking on her door.

It's over.

End Notes

I've been sitting on this since last November. This was initially supposed to be a tribute to vocalist Atsushi Sakurai of buck-tick, who died on October 19, 2023, but this has honestly grown into meaning so much more to me than just a tribute fic. Out of everything I've written, this is by and far my favorite work.

Please comment and Kudo if you enjoyed it. I'd love to hear your thoughts about it.

Title from the song Kiss Me Good-bye by Buck-Tick.

As always, special thanks to TheNotebookWizard and Paganaidd for beta reading this thing, and the many other people who've I've inflicted this upon in the last year, especially Kurt_Angle's_Tailbone.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!